

Stephanie Droop

Versatile former finance professional turns to research

Specialist in causal modelling

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stephaniedroop@gmail.com

University of Edinburgh, UK

In 2017 I left my chartered accountancy profession and went to grad school to learn causal ML research and data science because I want to use information to solve strategic and complex problems. I'm in my final year of PhD and looking to apply my skills to business.

Relevant skills

Data analysis and modelling

- Highly skilled in R and Python to process, manipulate, analyse and visualize data
- Build models out of programs and maths: Bayesian inference, causal structures, counterfactual samples
- Use ML concepts to validate and compare models: statistics and data science to validate results
- Developed new counterfactual reasoning model during PhD to solve abduction using unobserved variables
- Projected financials and doggedly investigated detailed accounts to save client £50 million in M&A deal (KPMG)

Research scientist leading project teams

- Formed 4 project teams to run primary behavioral research to advance field of causal cognition (4 conferences)
- Designed rigorous analyses of primary and secondary data for insights into how people explain (5 papers)
- Instigated department code review process to ensure reproducible workflow and results
- Created datasets, functions, scripts and models usable by others (see GitHub)
- Consultant on data-generating processes on engineering team (Seluna medtech start-up)

Written communication

- Published papers at ICML, CogSci, MathPsych, CHI
- Edited technical and financial due diligence reports to let clients negotiate price and buy right companies (KPMG)
- Reviewed for Journal of Experimental Psychology and many conferences

Oral communication

- Honed a compelling presenting style to galvanize interest in findings and field (2 lay talks, 3 conferences, many internal presentations, investor pitching, guest host on MLST podcast)
- Taught courses on Cognitive Science and Intro to Programming to inspire and encourage undergraduates

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Skills continued

Influence, leadership and vision

- Introduced own new “active editing” approach to work closer with project teams (KPMG)
- Influenced partners to fund chartership, thus join professional staff and transfer to a UK office (KPMG)
- Managed team of undergraduate researchers to produce dissertation projects and assistants to process data (PhD)
- Raised £1500 sponsorship to allow validation of health economics start-up while on incubator scheme
- Proactively shepherded 300-person residential meditation centre through regulatory and construction decisions to reopen under new covid restrictions while working as voluntary manager

Relevant education and employment

University of Edinburgh

PhD with integrated study

Centre for Doctoral Training in Natural Language Processing, School of Informatics, funded by UKRI

Sept 2021 – Aug 2025 (ongoing)

Working title of thesis: Counterfactual reasoning models of unconstrained verbal explanations

University of Edinburgh

MSc Human Cognitive Neuropsychology (distinction)

Sept 2018 – Aug 2021

University of Glasgow

MSc Psychological Studies (merit)

Conversion MSc = second undergrad. Large statistics and research methods component

Sept 2017 – Aug 2018

KPMG LLP

Editor and translator from Russian (Moscow) then Analyst, Deal Advisory (Aberdeen). Inc. funded accounting chartership

June 2011 – Aug 2017

OU Business School

Communications Consultant, between Milton Keynes and Moscow, responsible for partner institutes

2008